

## IT Act 2000

# Information Technology Act, 2000

*Information Technology (IT) Act, 2000*

**User Query :**

After a personal dispute, someone edited one of my photographs to make it appear intimate and circulated it through WhatsApp and social media without my permission. The person is also threatening to send the image to my employer and family unless I pay money. What legal provisions may apply to this situation?

**Job Id. :**

qwen3-30b/Scenario 4/Information Technology (IT) Act, 2000

**Prepared by :**

NyaySahayak

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**NyaySahayak**

*AI-Powered Legal Intelligence Platform*

## APPLICABLE SECTIONS

### Section 66E

#### — Punishment for violation of privacy

Only if the transmitted image is an image of a statutory 'private area' and the privacy conditions are met.

### Section 67

#### — Punishment for publishing or transmitting obscene material in electronic form

Depends on whether the morphed image is legally obscene.

### Section 67A

#### — Punishment for publishing or transmitting material containing sexually explicit act, etc., in electronic form

Depends on the actual content; an 'intimate-looking' image is not automatically sexually explicit within **section 67A**.

## INTERPRETATION & LEGAL ANALYSIS

*AI-generated legal interpretation*

- 1 The IT Act analysis should turn on the actual content of the morphed image. **Section 66E** is narrower than a general privacy offence and requires an image of a 'private area'. Sections 67/67A depend on obscenity or sexually explicit content.

## ✓ STRENGTHS & RIGHTS

- 1 The image was circulated electronically without permission.

## ✗ RISKS & OBLIGATIONS

- 1 Do not automatically label every morphed or embarrassing photo as **section 66E /67A**; inspect the statutory content elements.

## PROCEDURAL NOTES & COMPLIANCE STEPS

*Actionable steps for compliance and grievance redressal*

## COMPLIANCE STEPS

1. Preserve the original and morphed versions, message chains, URLs/account identifiers and timestamps.

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